Heights of Winter 2012

"Cotswold"

12 and 6 hour Rogaines
Saturday 30th June 2012

Team No.

Dear Team,

Thank you for your entry. Please get your team number from the website, enter it here, bring it with you, and remember it.

The team contact person must ensure team members are familiar with all the information below. It is also accessible at http://www.rogaine.org.nz. We hope you enjoy the Heights of Winter as much as we have enjoyed organising it.

Getting to the event

REGISTRATION is in the Omihi Community hall which is on the corner of SH1 and Reeces Rd., a 70 minute drive north of Christchurch. Travelling N on SH1 through Amberley, and Waipara, watch for a "Rogaine" sign 8.5km along SH1. 200m past the sign turn right into Reeces Rd. **Take care as you are turning right off SH1.** Park along the road. Take care walking back to the hall.

Coming from the north on SH1 Reeces Rd. is 12km south of Greta Valley.

START/FINISH is at the Woolshed on Cotswold farm 7 km further along Reeces Rd. past REGISTRATION.

Both the **6hr snack** and the **meal after the 12hr event** will be served at the Omihi Hall, where the registration was done. Results will be announced there too.

Registration

At registration at the Omihi hall ensure your team is together and that you have your **completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact form** (included below) with you and that your team number is noted on the form. Your team will then be issued with:

- an event map (A3, 1:33,000 scale topo map oriented to magnetic north), a checkpoint description sheet, and an A3 zip lock plastic bag per team member
- a single black and white A4 version of the map to be used as your "flight plan". Enter your team number and plot your intended route on this map, including direction of travel, and return it to registration. You may subsequently modify your route according to conditions as you progress, but the flight plan will give us some idea of where to start looking if you are in trouble.
- Electronic wrist-tags – two per team. These must be worn on the wrist with the security band provided.

Start

After you have finished planning and have filed your flight plan your team must then drive from REGISTRATION the 7 km to the START/FINISH (Cotswold Rd) to be well ready for the briefing that takes place 15min before your event starts, (i.e. 8.45 and 10.45 am sharp). We recommend that you depart Registration for the Start/Finish by 8.15 am for the 12hr event or 10.15am for the 6hr event. Parking will be tight especially if wet.

All members of your team must attend the event briefing. Each person in your team issued with a wrist-tag must register their wrist-tag on one of the BRIEF Punches as you enter the briefing area. For details on using the NavLight Electronic Scoring System see the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz.

Finish

As soon as you finish register your wrist-tag on any one of several FINISH Punches, assemble your team, and then present yourselves to the computer desk (in the woolshed) to have your wrist-tags removed by an organiser and scored. (Competitors must NOT remove wrist-tags). Wait for an immediate printout of your score. If you have any disagreement with it, see the event organiser, not the scoring team. Scores will be available on the day and will be published on http://www.rogaine.org.nz as soon as possible after the event.

Your event will close after the 12 or 6 hrs has elapsed. Aim to finish on time as you will be penalised 10 points per minute late and if you are over 30 minutes late you lose all your points.

Event chronology

	12hr	**6hr**
REGISTRATION OPENS Route planning and preparation	7 am	9.30am
Depart for START/FINISH by:	8.15 am	10.15 am
Briefing at START/FINISH	8.45am	10.45am
START	9am	11am
FINISH	9pm	5pm
RESULTS	ASAP after 9.30pm	ASAP after 5.30pm
For the 12hr competitors there will be a basic meal at the Omihi Hall from 8.30 pm. For the 6hr competitors we will provide a snack at the Omihi Hall from 4.30 pm.		

What to bring

Clothing and safety equipment is listed under 'Safety Sheet'. You will also need

- a range of marker pens, pencils and highlighters, pins and string, and ruler, for planning and measuring your route before you start
- eating utensils for the meal after the event (cutlery, plate, mug)

Navigation devices such as altimeters or GPS, including altimeters within watches and GPS within cellphones, are **not allowed**.

Food and drink.

Carry enough for a long day in the field. You may return to the start-finish at any time for a rest, or a drink. Two water refill drops around the course are marked on the map. Please conserve this water when filling bottles. We suggest you do not draw water from streams.

Event procedure

We recommend you spend at least one hour (12 hour event) or 45 minutes (6 hour event) planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding. There will be a large inside area for planning at the Omihi Hall for both events. There is a woolshed and large covered yard/barn area at the START/FINISH with limited lighting if you want to plan there.

You should plan your route carefully, aiming to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but to stay within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, your experience and fitness. If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, we suggest you confine your route to the more easily accessible check points.

Your team may visit any number of check points and in any order. Your aim is to maximise your 'score'. The checkpoints each have a unique number and the score value is the first digit followed by a zero. Thus checkpoint number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90 points. Any checkpoints numbered in the range 100 to 109 are worth 100 points.

All teams start together. Concentrate on your own team plan; do not try to follow other teams, or get distracted by them.

Each checkpoint consists of an orange/white flag tied to a bush, post, fibreglass pole or other object and an electronic punch. These are not hidden and should be visible from at least 10 meters away, depending on your approach. As they have been placed in the field a week or more before the event we cannot be certain that all are still intact so if a checkpoint is missing you must be able to describe its presumed location to the score keepers to be credited with the points.

When you visit a checkpoint "punch" your tag until a red flashing light is seen. (Less than 3 seconds, and probably half a second). All the wrist tags assigned to a team must record a visit to a checkpoint to gain points for that checkpoint. If the punch doesn't flash, write down the 3-letter code visible inside it. (See the top of the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz to access further details on 'NAVLIGHT').

A full set of rules governing Rogaining in New Zealand is available under "Resources" at www.rogaine.org.nz.

Safety Sheet - Heights of Winter
12 and 6 hour Rogaines - Saturday 30th June 2012

Cancellation
This event will be cancelled only if conditions are extreme. The organisers reserve the right to shorten the event by time or geography for safety or other reasons.

Compulsory clothes and equipment:

Per team member:	thermal top & trousers	thermal hat and gloves
	shower proof/windproof coat	survival sheet or pack liner
	whistle, torch/head torch	food, water bottle
	suitable, robust, well-fitting footwear with well-treaded soles	

Per team:	first aid kit	at least one compass
	watch	pencil or fine spirit marker

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We **strongly recommend** you also carry:
a fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters, showerproof over trousers, a high-visibility reflective garment to warn traffic after dusk, a compass each, watch each.

Safety is a top priority during this event. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety. Your responsibilities include:

- being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers in writing, on the event web site, or verbal briefings,
- carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment,
- advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event,
- staying together as a team at all times, and providing mutual support, and helping any other team you find in difficulties,
- depositing a 'flight plan' map showing your intended course at registration before you start,
- recording your team's visit to a checkpoint with the electronic punch,
- advising organisers and returning your tags if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- being highly conscious of time and avoiding a late return – being late results in a hefty points penalty as well as raising safety concerns,
- being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this,
- monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required,
- looking out for hazards, such as:

1. **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Be prepared to seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. Reeces Rd will be patrolled from time to time through the day. In severe weather, keep off high, exposed ridges.
2. **Dehydration.** Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person. Water drops are marked on the map. (We recommend you don't drink from local streams).

3. **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.
4. **Cliffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, incised creeks, gullies, slippery grass, hidden obstacles such as logs, loose fencing wire**, etc. may be present throughout the event area.
5. **Collapsed tunnels or 'under-runners',** especially on farm tracks
6. **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud, and descend out of it as soon as possible.
7. **Road Hazard:** There will be light traffic on roads. No roads are closed during the event.
8. The R**oad Code applies at all times; keep to the side of the road and be alert to traffic**. We recommend you wear clothing with high visibility from dusk.
9. **Hunters**: There are unlikely to be any hunters in the rogaine area.
10. **Deer fences (1.8 m netting)**. Please cross at corners, main posts, or gates. Paddocks that contain farmed deer are out of bounds and will be identified as such on the map.
11. **Electric fences**. Usually the top wire, but sometimes a lower wire, may be hot (look for insulators on the post). Some fences have outriggers that may be hot. Treat all as ON. Climb through lower wires, or use parka, pack or map for insulation. (Some fences need a good thickness of insulation).

In the event of serious injury or exhaustion, make the injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the nearest road. Emergency signal – repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast. If you become totally disorientated, travel down slope to sheltered ground, preferably to a road.

Note: There is no cell-phone coverage on the course

IT IS MID WINTER – BE PREPARED

We can give no assurance that teams unable to make their own way to the finish, or a road, can be assisted until after daybreak on Sunday.

Environmental and farm care

Rogaining is an environmentally & socially friendly activity and we expect you to reinforce this ethic.

- Respect farm stock, fences and other facilities, and the right for landowners to operate their business, and lifestyle.
- **LEAVE GATES AS YOU FIND THEM.** They will usually be shut. Shut them if you have any doubt.
- Cross fences, where you must, at a strainer post, or climb through, do not spring off the top wire.
- Report any damage or distress to stock to the organizers.
- Protect plants and animals
- Remove rubbish – more importantly, don't create it in the first place
- Bury toilet waste - better still, don't create it in the field - use the toilets provided at the event centre where possible.
- Keep streams clean

Farmers are concerned about the spread of Chilean Needle Grass so we would ask that all competitors wear gaiters or putties so that socks do not pick up seeds.

This event is wholly on private land and we gratefully thank the 8 farming families who have welcomed us for this event. Please ensure the trust they have placed in us is justified.

Thank you, Dave, Pete & team.

BASIC INFORMATION

Rules in brief

- Navigate with compass and rogaine event map only. GPS and/or altimeter units are not allowed, including watches with altimeters and cellphones with GPS.
- Travel only on foot.
- Team members are to stay within verbal contact of each other at all times. All team tags must be punched at a checkpoint. If a check point is missing, be able to describe the local setting in detail to the organiser at the finish to verify your visit.
- When visiting the START/FINISH, all team members must report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. You may still go out again later.
- If a competitor wishes to withdraw, the entire team must return to the START/FINISH and notify the organisers. The team retains current points score. Teams of one are not permitted.
- Event finishes at 9pm (12 hr) or 5pm (6 hr); or as specified at the start.
- When your team finishes, all members must report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags, then **IMMEDIATELY** report to the scoring table to have your wrist-tags removed and scored.

Procedure at each checkpoint

- All team members must use the electronic punch to register on their wrist-tags. If a punch fails to operate record its internal 3-letter code (visible through the clear plastic) to verify your visit, and after you finish and have returned your tags inform the event organiser.

Points value, penalty points

- Checkpoints in the range 100 to 109 are worth 100 points. Otherwise, checkpoints 20 to 29 are worth 20 points, 30 to 39 are worth 30 points, etc.
- 10 points penalty for each minute late. 30 minutes late - all points lost

Safety

- Carry and wear suitable clothing and equipment
- Team to remain together at all times
- Be alert to exhaustion, dehydration, sun, and/or hypothermia
- Help other teams having problems
- If your team withdraws from the event you **must report to the organisers at the START/FINISH**. Otherwise you will be reported overdue and a search will be mounted.
- **Take extreme care on roads, which remain open to traffic.**

Emergencies

- Emergency signal: repeated, short whistle blasts
- Repeat if you hear one long blast

Serious injury

- Make injured person warm and comfortable
- Leave someone with the injured person if there are more than two in the team.
- Note your exact location on map
- Seek help via nearest safe route or road and return to base

Farm/land courtesy

- Keep clear of buildings, machinery
- Out of bounds means OUT OF BOUNDS
- No **rubbish**, no **dogs**, no **fires**, no **firearms,**
- Report any damage, etc. to event organisers

A full set of rules and code of conduct governing rogaining in New Zealand is available on www.rogaine.org.nz

TEAM NUMBER: _____

Heights of Winter - Saturday 30th June 2012

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following has been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity (signed by each member of a team)

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organizers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact for each member of a team

Your name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18.
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.